

LOGIC



ARISTOTLE

A view of a statue in a Vienna museum.
Courtesy of *Scripta Mathematica*.

2-1 STATEMENTS

Everyone thinks he knows what a *statement* is. A politician issues a *statement* when he concedes defeat during an election. The plumber sends your father a *statement* after installing a new sink. But in mathematics we use the term in a narrow technical sense. We mentioned in the first chapter that clear, precise definitions are necessary. Accordingly, we make the following definition, which turns out to be very useful.

Definition 2-1. A statement is a sentence which is either true or false, but not both.

Consider the following:

- (a) Go back home.
- (b) $2 \times 2 = 5$.
- (c) $2 \times 2 = 4$.
- (d) New York is a suburb of Los Angeles.
- (e) Thursday up tar paper.
- (f) The silliness of speedily.

Some of the above are statements and some are not. Before reading on, decide for yourself which ones satisfy the definition.

Let us look at some slightly different examples.

- (a) I am the most beautiful girl in town.
- (b) If I don't get a good night's sleep, I can't pass the examination.
- (c) $x + 2 = 5$.

All of these are sensible sentences. The only question is whether or not they satisfy our condition of being either true or false but not both. Before we can decide whether (a) is a true statement or a false statement we must know who "I" is and what town is meant. Then we can decide upon the truth or falsity. (We could hold a beauty contest!) In (c) if we replace the letter x by "3," we have a true statement. If we replace x by "2" the

resulting statement is false. In statement (b), we must again know who "I" is and what examination is meant in order to decide whether it is a true or false statement.

Besides rather simple statements, we can have more complicated ones, such as:

- I cannot go to the dance because I have nothing to wear, my feet hurt, and I can't dance.
- A triangle has three equal sides if and only if it has three equal angles.
- Jones is a mathematician and Smith is an engineer, while Brown doesn't work at all.
- There is one and only one line through two points.
- Either I will marry you or get a new job.
- Two lines either intersect or are parallel.

In some of these examples the full statement is made up of simpler statements. We see that statements may be combined to give more complicated statements. For example:

"Mr. Baker is a barber," "Mr. Barber is a baker,"

are two statements. We can combine them into a single statement by joining them with "and."

"Mr. Baker is a barber and Mr. Barber is a baker."

Here are some examples of combining two statements. Make up some others of your own.

- We are having a picnic and it is not raining.
- It is night and I can hear the wind.
- Mary is going with Fred and Suzie is going with John.
- I like spinach and I dislike candy.
- You are rich and I am poor.
- Thursday is April second and the moon is made of green cheese.

To be perfectly clear about combining statements, we indicate statements by letters, using Greek letters like α (alpha), β (beta), γ (gamma). Now if we let α indicate the statement "Mr. Barber is a baker" and let β indicate "Mr. Baker is a barber," then the statement "Mr. Barber is a baker and Mr. Baker is a barber" may be written " α and β ."

Problem. In each of the combined statements (a) through (f) above, pick out the two statements which form it. Note that each statement has the form " α and β ."

The combination of two statements with "and" to get a new statement has a name. We emphasize this by making the definition:

Definition 2-2. If α and β are statements, the statement " α and β " is called the *conjunction* of α and β .

You should not accept definitions blindly. It is possible to sneak a false statement into a definition! Such a definition would be worthless. From the way Definition 2-2 is worded it is clear that we have *taken for granted* that " α and β " will always be a statement. But a sentence is not a statement (according to Definition 2-1) unless it is either true or false. Therefore, we must decide upon some *rule* which will enable us to say when " α and β " is true and when it is false. If we cannot agree upon such a rule, Definition 2-2 will be meaningless.

The following statements are all of the form " α and β ." Decide which ones are true and which ones are false, and then try to state a general rule for deciding upon the truth of such statements.

- $2 \times 2 = 4$ and $2 + 2 = 5$.
- $3 + 2 = 5$ and there are at least 52 Sundays in every year.
- A triangle has three sides and a pentagon has six sides.
- Every rectangle is a square and all men have purple hair.
- The positive square root of 16 is 4 and the negative square root of 16 is -4.

You will probably have no trouble coming to the same conclusion that mathematicians have agreed upon. That is, " α and β " is considered true when both α and β are true. If one of the statements is false (or both are), then " α and β " is false. We can describe this rule most clearly by the *truth table* below.

α	β	α and β
T	T	T
T	F	F
F	T	F
F	F	F

The table is self-explanatory. It points out that " α and β " is true (T) in only one case and false (F) in all others.

The next step in our development of logic will be harder. We can combine statements in another way by putting the word "or" between them. For example:

I will go to the movies *or* I will stay home.

I will receive an A in geometry *or* Latin.

State University will not admit you unless you have had a year of Spanish *or* a year of Latin.

Study the three statements above carefully. Everyone would agree that in the first statement the speaker means that he will go to the movie

or he will stay home *but he will not do both*. In the second statement does the speaker mean that he will get *either* an A in geometry *or* an A in Latin *but not both*? Or does he mean that he is sure of getting one A and perhaps he will get two? Of course there is no question about the last statement. State University will not refuse to admit you because you had one year of Spanish *and* one year of Latin.

We are pointing out that in everyday speech we use the word "or" ambiguously. Sometimes when we say " α or β " we mean that *one and only one* of the statements is true. Sometimes we mean that at least one is true and possibly both are. We cannot use the word "or" with this double meaning in mathematics. We must explain precisely what we mean when we say " α or β ." Mathematicians have agreed to call statements of the form " α or β " true in all cases except when α and β are both false. Of course this differs from the ordinary usage of the word "or." But we use everyday language too carelessly for our purpose in mathematics. We must be able to express ourselves precisely and know that our meaning will not be misunderstood. You must remember that when we say " α or β " we mean that either α is true and β is false, *or* α is false and β is true, *or* α is true and β is true. We make the following formal definition.

Definition 2-3. The statement " α or β " is called the *disjunction* of α and β . It is false when both α and β are false and true in all other cases.

Problem. Construct the truth table for the statement " α or β ."

Exercise Group 2-1

In each exercise below there are two statements. Form their conjunction and disjunction. Discuss the resulting statements with respect to truth and falsity.

- | | |
|---|---|
| 1. Some roses are red. Some violets are blue. | 4. Napoleon was an emperor of Japan. Marco Polo discovered America. |
| 2. September has 30 days. There are eight days in a week. | 5. $2 + 2 = 5$; $6 + 3 = 9$. |
| 3. 3 is less than 4. 4 is less than 3. | 6. $7 + 4 = 11$; $8 + 0 = 9$. |
| | 7. $1 + 1 = 2$; $1 \times 1 = 2$. |
| | 8. $5 + 1 = 5$; $5 \times 1 = 6$. |

2-2 NEGATION

Sometimes we make statements about other statements. One of the simplest and most useful statements of this type has the form " α is false." At times you may make a statement that you believe true, and someone else may show his disagreement by saying, "That is not true." Just as we use the terms *conjunction* and *disjunction* to describe the statements " α and β " and " α or β ," so also we have a particular name for the statement " α is false."

Definition 2-4. The statement " α is false" is called the *negation* of α (and will be written, and read, "not α ").

Problem. State a rule for determining when "not α " is true and when it is false. Make a truth table for "not α ."

When we form the negation of a statement in words we do not usually place "not" in front of it. Logically it would be correct to do so, but the resulting sentence might sound awkward. For example, let α be "a square is a rectangle." Anyone untrained in logic would have a right to complain that he did not understand our meaning if we said, "not a square is a rectangle." The examples below indicate how negations may be formed. After studying these, make up several examples of your own.

- (a) α : A square is a rectangle.
not α : A square is not a rectangle.
- (b) α : $2 + 2 = 4$.
not α : $2 + 2 \neq 4$.
- (c) α : A triangle has five sides.
not α : A triangle does not have five sides.
- (d) α : It is false that my donkey has three legs.
not α : My donkey has three legs.

Exercise Group 2-2

Form negations of the following statements.

- | | |
|--|--------------------------------|
| 1. The grass in my yard is green. | 6. $5 + 4 = 9$. |
| 2. This rose is black. | 7. $6 + 3 = 7$. |
| 3. I am tired. | *8. $x = 2$ and $y = 3$. |
| 4. The temperature of the sun is more than 1000 degrees. | *9. $x = 2$ or $y = 3$. |
| 5. Geometry is interesting. | *10. All pigs are fat. |
| | *11. Some Americans are liars. |

Sometimes we wish to state the negation of a statement like "All cats are black." If we can find *one* cat which is not black we will have proved this statement false. Hence we form the negation of "All cats are black" by saying "There is at least one cat which is not black" or "Some cat is not black." The most common error made in forming the negation of a statement like "All students in this class like geometry" is to say "No student in this class likes geometry." These statements certainly do not agree but they are definitely not negations of each other. Why? Remember that if α is false then "not α " must be true, for "not α " states that α is false. Show that the statements, "All students in this class like

*Starred exercises, sections, theorems, etc., are optional.

geometry" and "No student in this class likes geometry," could both be false.

Another common error is to negate "All cats are black" by saying "All cats are not black." Although in everyday speech this sentence might be understood to mean "Not all cats are black," we do not interpret it so. If we say "All cats are red," we mean *every cat has the property of being red*. So we interpret "All cats are not black" to mean *every cat has the property of being not black*. This is a subtle distinction, and again it points out that the precise language of mathematics differs from careless, everyday speech.

Exercise Group 2-3

Give the negation of each statement.

1. All men in Georgia are at least six feet tall.
2. All students in France like geometry.
3. All students in Russia hate geometry.
4. Every rectangle is a square.
5. Every triangle is equilateral.
6. All gadgets are widgets.
7. All miggles are maggles.
- *8. For every pair of numbers a and b , $a + b = b + a$.
9. Every circle has a center.

Consider the statement "Some cats are black." We usually understand the word "some" to mean "more than one." But in logic it is more convenient to agree that it means "one or more." (We must have precise definitions!) The negation of "Some cats are black" then becomes "No cat is black." We could also say, "Every cat is a color different from black" or "Every cat is not black." Notice again that this last statement, "Every cat is not black," means something altogether different from "Not every cat is black."

Exercise Group 2-4

Give negations of the following statements. After doing this, make up some examples of your own.

1. Some men play golf.
2. Some boys play football.
3. There is at least one equilateral triangle.
4. For some numbers x , $x^2 + 2 = 5$.
5. There is at least one number x such that $x + 3 = 7$.
6. There is at least one number x such that $x^2 + 2 = 0$.
7. Some dogs have fewer than four legs.
- *8. Some numbers are negative.
9. Some fishermen always tell the truth.
10. Some people work hard.

When we have two statements, α and β , and wish to form the *negation* of their *conjunction*, we must think a little harder than before. Thus if we wish to form the negation of "Smith is a dentist and Jones is a teacher," we must say that the statement is false. By our agreement

in Section 2-1, we must say that at least one of the statements "Smith is a dentist" and "Jones is a teacher" is false. We do this by saying, "Smith is *not* a dentist *or* Jones is *not* a teacher."

As another illustration, suppose one student says, "We will win our game with Lincoln *and* we will win our game with Bay City." To call his statement false is to say, "We will *not* win our game with Lincoln *or* we will *not* win our game with Bay City." It should be clear now that the negation of " α and β " is the statement "*not* α *or* *not* β ."

Problem. Construct a truth table for each of the statements " α and β " and "*not* α *or* *not* β ." Show that when one statement is true the other is false, and vice versa.

Exercise Group 2-5

Give the negations of the statements below. Make up some additional exercises of your own.

1. Today is Monday and the weather is cold.
2. $x = 2$ and $y = 5$.
3. $2 \times 2 = 4$ and $3 \times 5 = 15$.
4. $\triangle ABC$ is isosceles and $\triangle ABC$ is a right triangle.
5. The point A is on the line l and the point B is on the line m .
- *6. All cats are black and all men are mortal.
- *7. All cats are black and some birds are blue.
- *8. Some rectangles are squares and some triangles are equilateral.
- *9. Some widgets are gadgets and no wiggles are waggles.

We may wish to form the *negation* of the *disjunction* of two statements. For example, we may wish to deny the statement "Johnson is a tailor or Brown is a doctor." You should have no trouble expressing the negation of this statement.

Problem. State the general rule for forming the negation of the disjunction of two statements. Do so by completing the sentence, "The negation of ' α or β ' is _____." Construct a truth table for each of the statements " α or β " and "*not* α *and* *not* β ."

Exercise Group 2-6

Give the negation of each statement below. Invent some more examples.

1. I will go to the game or I will go to the movie.
2. I will study hard or I will fail.
3. We will start at 6:30 or we will be late.
4. A donkey has three legs or a rabbit has long ears.
5. $2 + 2 = 5$ or $2 + 2 = 6$.
6. $3 \times 7 = 21$ or $4 \times 5 = 20$.
7. Billings is right or Jones is wrong.
- *8. Some will work or all will starve.
- *9. Every triangle is isosceles or every triangle is right.
- *10. No roses are red or some violets are blue.

2-3 WHAT ARE PROOFS?

In everyday life when trying to convince a person that something is true, we may say, "This is true because that is true." For such a statement to be convincing, both sides in the argument must agree that the *that* is true and the *this* must then *necessarily* follow. In other words, there must be agreement as to what information we start with and how we draw conclusions from this information. *Logic is the study of the rules for making correct statements.* Proof always consists of making statements of the following type: If so and so is true, then such and such must also be true. For example, consider the statement, "If the sky is blue (no clouds at all), then it is not raining." Everyone would agree to this statement because from our experience we know that rain invariably comes from clouds. However, the following statement, which you might hear in a political speech, is not logically correct. "The United States is the best country because it is a democracy." That we are a democracy is true; that we are the best country (whatever that means) may be true although it would not be accepted by all. The logical error comes from the fact that there are other democratic countries, and hence they too by our careless reasoning should be best. Therefore, that the United States is best does not follow from the fact that we are a democracy.

Here are simple examples from algebra:

"If $3x = 4$, then $x = \frac{4}{3}$."

"If $a = 2$ and $b = 3$, then $a^2 + ab = 10$."

Both of these statements are correct and both are of the form, "If α then β ." All mathematical proofs employ statements of this type. We express such a statement another way by saying

α implies β .

For example, let α be the statement "Today is Monday" and let β be the statement "Tomorrow is Tuesday." Then the statement "if α then β " is certainly true. However, the statement "If the sun comes up tomorrow, then it will not rise the next day" is very probably false. At least we shall hope that it turns out to be false. It is fortunate that statements like "If he takes her to the dance, then I'll never speak to him again" and "If our party loses the election, then the country will be ruined" are usually false. It is convenient to have a symbolic way to indicate that α implies β . We shall write this as

$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$,

where you should read the arrow as the word "implies." We call the statement " α implies β " an *implication*.

Exercise Group 2-7

Put the following statements in an "if α then β " form so that α implies β .

1. If I eat strawberries I get hives.
2. The picnic will be canceled in case of rain.
3. We will win the game if Jonesvitch plays.
4. Numbers larger than 5 are positive.
5. $x^2 = y^2$ because $x = y$.
6. $3x^2 - 2 = 10$ when $x = 2$.
7. A geometric figure which is a square is not a circle.
8. Squares are rectangles.
9. The area of a rectangle with sides of length a and b is ab .
10. With a million dollars, I'd eat steak for breakfast.
11. People who don't study mathematics don't have good sense.
12. When it rains my rheumatism bothers me.
13. When I study I do well in school.
14. People who do not vote are poor citizens.
15. Two lines which intersect are not parallel.
16. I know that $x = 2$ because $3x = 6$.
17. Satisfaction guaranteed or your money back.
18. I know $3x = 6$ because $x = 2$.
19. I will not go to the party if Jimmy is coming.
20. This shirt will not shrink or your money will be refunded.
21. This shirt will shrink or your money will be refunded.
22. To remain free we must vote in elections.
23. The crops will be saved if we have rain this week.
24. The crops will be saved only if we have rain this week.
25. I will go to the dance if Joe asks me.
26. I will go to the dance only if Joe asks me.
27. It will rain tomorrow if it turns cold.
28. It will rain tomorrow only if it turns cold.

Working with statements of the form " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " is called *deductive reasoning* or, in everyday language, *drawing conclusions*. The statement α is called the *hypothesis* and the statement β is called the *conclusion*. We use this method of reasoning in daily life when we try to prove to someone that some statement β is true. We try to find another statement α which implies β , and which is true. Then we say, " α is true, therefore β is true."

Exercise Group 2-8

In Exercises 1 through 7, a statement $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is given which is to be accepted as true. What conclusion can you draw if (a) is true? if (b) is true?

1. If Fred is on the team he must go to bed early.
 - (a) Fred goes to bed early.
 - (b) Fred does not go to bed early.
2. If a man is a postman he has foot trouble.
 - (a) This man has perfect feet.
 - (b) That man has foot trouble.
3. You will be given a ticket if you are a sophomore.
 - (a) Jim was not given a ticket.
 - (b) Joe was given a ticket.

4. You will be given a ticket only if you are a sophomore.
(a) Jean was given a ticket. (b) George is a sophomore.
5. If two triangles have equal bases and heights then they have equal areas.
(a) These triangles have equal areas. (b) These triangles do not have equal areas and they do have equal heights.
6. The house will burn down if we don't get some water.
(a) We did not get any water. (b) We did get some water.
7. If a man is beheaded in June then he will die before July 4.
(a) This man died before July 4. (b) Smith was not beheaded in June.

Is the reasoning in Exercises 8 through 18 correct? Invent some other examples illustrating both correct and incorrect reasoning.

8. All men are mortal. Socrates is a man.
Conclusion: Socrates is mortal.
9. All widgets are gadgets. This is a gadget.
Conclusion: This is a widget.
10. All widgets are gadgets. This is not a gadget.
Conclusion: This is not a widget.
11. Only widgets are gadgets. This is a gadget.
Conclusion: This is a widget.
12. Only widgets are gadgets. This is a widget.
Conclusion: This is a gadget.
13. Every equilateral triangle is isosceles. $\triangle ABC$ is isosceles.
Conclusion: $\triangle ABC$ is equilateral.
14. Parallel lines do not intersect. Lines r and s intersect.
Conclusion: Lines r and s are not parallel.
15. All of these dresses will shrink if washed in hot water. This dress did shrink.
Conclusion: It was washed in hot water.
16. All sweet food has honey in it. This food is sweet.
Conclusion: It has honey in it.
17. All sweet food has honey in it. This food doesn't have honey in it.
Conclusion: It is not sweet.
18. All sweet food has honey in it. This food is not sweet.
Conclusion: It does not have honey in it.

2-4 THE TRUTH TABLE FOR IMPLICATION

If α and β are statements, then " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " should be another statement. In other words, " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " must be either true or false. In that case we must agree on a way of determining whether " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " is true or false.

The definition we give may seem a bit strange at first, but keep in mind two things that may help you. In the first place the definition below is

precise. In the second place we want to use the implication $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ only when the hypothesis α is presumed true.

Definition 2-5. $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is true whenever the statement " $(\text{not } \alpha) \text{ or } \beta$ " is true. It is false when the statement " $(\text{not } \alpha) \text{ or } \beta$ " is false.

The truth table, then, is as follows.

α	β	$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$	$(\text{not } \alpha) \text{ or } \beta$
T	T	T	T
T	F	F	F
F	F	T	T
F	T	T	T

The last line may surprise you. Just remember that $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ means that β is true or α is false and that β is true if α is true.

Exercise Group 2-9

The exercises referred to below are those in Exercise Group 2-8.

1. Write each statement $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ in implications in Exercises 1 through 7 in this language.
2. Re-examine the validity of the conclusions in Exercises 8 through 18.
3. A statement $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is also sometimes expressed as " α is sufficient for β ," or " α suffices for β ," or again, "for β to be true it is sufficient that α be true." Thus for x^2 to equal 4 it is sufficient that $x = -2$. Express the
4. A statement $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is also sometimes expressed as " β is necessary for α " or "in order that α be true it is necessary that β be true." Thus for x to equal -2 it is necessary that $x^2 = 4$. Express the implications in Exercises 1 through 7 in this language.

2-5 THE CONVERSE OF AN IMPLICATION

From one implication " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " we can form others which may or may not be true. One way of doing this gives what we call the *converse*.

Definition 2-6. The *converse* of " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " is " $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$."

Example 1. $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$: If an animal is a man then it is a human being.

Converse: $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$: If an animal is a human being then it is a man.

In this example " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " is true but " $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$ " is false.

Example 2. $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$: If $\triangle ABC$ is equilateral then $\triangle ABC$ is equiangular.

Converse: $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$: If $\triangle ABC$ is equiangular, then $\triangle ABC$ is equilateral.

In this example both " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " and " $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$ " are true.

Exercise Group 2-10

Write the converse of the following statements. In each exercise decide whether the statement is true or false. Do the same thing for the converse.

1. Every man born in Indiana is an American citizen.
2. If $x = y + 3$, then x is greater than y .
3. If two rectangles have equal bases and equal altitudes, they have equal areas.
4. If $x^2 = 9$, then $x = 3$ or $x = -3$.
5. If a man is a Polynesian, he is at least six feet tall.
6. If plants are green, they must have had sunshine.
7. If a point is on the perpendicular bisector of a line segment, it is equidistant from the endpoints of the segment.
8. If I am sleeping, then I am breathing.
9. If $2 + 4 = 5$, then $4 + 7 = 10$.
10. If $2 + 4 = 5$, then $4 + 7 = 11$.
11. If $2 + 4 = 6$, then $4 + 7 = 10$.
12. If $2 + 4 = 6$, then $4 + 7 = 11$.

2-6 EQUIVALENT STATEMENTS

When two people give the same mathematical proof they probably will not make exactly the same statements. But it is very likely that at certain places in their proofs they will make statements which we say are *equivalent* to one another. In order to understand precisely what this means we make the following definition.

Definition 2-7. Two statements α , β are said to be *equivalent* to one another if *both* the statement $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ and the converse $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$ are true. If α and β are equivalent statements, we indicate this by writing $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$, which we read as " α implies β and β implies α ."

This definition may be difficult to understand. An explanation is that "equivalent statements present the same information—they may simply be stated differently."

An example of a pair of equivalent statements is

- α : Line l is perpendicular to line m .
 β : Line m is perpendicular to line l .

Exercise Group 2-11

In 1 through 7 below decide whether the statements are equivalent to one another. Invent a few examples of pairs of statements which are equivalent to one another and some which are not.

1. α : Point P lies on the circle with center at O and radius five inches.
 β : The length of the line segment OP is five inches.
2. α : Line l is parallel to line m .
 β : Line n is parallel to line m .

3. α : x is greater than y .
 β : y is less than x .
4. α : $2x + 3 = 17$.
 β : $x = 7$.
5. α : This geometric figure is a square.
 β : This geometric figure is a special kind of parallelogram.
6. α : $\triangle ABC$ is equilateral.
 β : $\triangle ABC$ is equiangular.
7. α : $x = 3$ or $x = -3$.
 β : $x^2 = 9$.

*8. A statement $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$ is also sometimes expressed by saying, "In order that α be true it is necessary and sufficient that β be true." In each of the above problems state the equivalence of α and β in this language.

Exercises 4 and 7 above illustrate that equivalent statements have an important place in algebra. See if you can prove that the following statement is true:

If two statements α , β are equivalent to each other, then either both are true or both are false.

An easy way to prove this is to complete the following truth table. Can you understand how this table really presents a proof?

α	β	$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$	$\beta \rightarrow \alpha$	$\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$
T	T	T	T	?
T	F	F	T	?
F	T	T	F	?
F	F	T	T	?

This truth table must be used together with Definition 2-7. By this definition we know whether to mark $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$ as true or false. Studying the table, we see that according to Definition 2-7, the statement $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$ must be labeled true on lines 1 and 4 and labeled false on lines 2 and 3. It should be easy for you to complete the proof.

Exercise Group 2-12

Form statements equivalent to those listed below. If you are not sure of the equivalence, make a truth table and check your work.

1. $x + y = 7$ and $x - y = 3$.
2. x is greater than y .
3. Line segments AB and CD do not intersect.
4. There is a point P which lies on both of the lines l and m .
5. Whether you are a smoker or whether you are not, whether you are married or single, whether you are a church member or not, you will like Dum-Dums.
6. This geometric figure has four sides, and pairs of opposite sides are parallel to one another.
7. That figure is a triangle.
8. This geometric figure consists of two points A and B and all the points between A and B .
9. The points A and B lie on the same side of the line l .
10. The points A and B lie on opposite sides of the line l .

2-7 THE CONTRAPOSITIVE OF AN IMPLICATION

A second important implication related to $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is its *contrapositive*.

Definition 2-8. The statement "not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α " is called the *contrapositive* of the statement " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$."

Examples:

- (a) $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$: $x = 3 \rightarrow x^2 = 9$.
not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α : $x^2 \neq 9 \rightarrow x \neq 3$.
- (b) $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$: If two lines intersect they are not parallel.
not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α : If two lines are parallel they do not intersect.
- (c) $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$: If I make an A on the examination I will receive an A in the course.
not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α : If I do not receive an A in the course then I will not have made an A on the examination.
- (d) $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$: If I go to the game I will not go to the movie.
not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α : If I go to the movie I will not go to the game.

The most interesting property of the statement "not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α " is that it is equivalent to $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$. We can prove this by showing that these two implications have identical truth tables.

Problem. Complete the following truth table and show that " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " and "not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α " are equivalent to each other.

α	β	not α	not β	$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$	not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α
T	T	F	F	—	—
T	F	F	T	—	—
F	T	T	F	—	—
F	F	T	T	—	—

Exercise Group 2-13

Form the contrapositive of each statement in 1 through 8 below.

- If $2 \times 2 = 4$, then oranges are composed of uranium.
- If you can run the mile in four minutes, then I'll eat my hat.
- If the ground hog sees his shadow, then we will have a cold spring.
- If there is no atmosphere on Mars, then there is no life there.
- If point P is on line r , then it is not on line s .
- If you are not satisfied, then your money will be returned.
- If food is sweet, then it has honey in it.
- If you always obey traffic laws, then you will not be given a ticket.
- Using the word *necessary*, state the contrapositive of the implication of Exercise 4.
- Using the word *sufficient*, state the contrapositive of the implication of Exercise 4.

2-8 "IF AND ONLY IF"

Consider the two statements " α if β " and " α only if β ." Our experience in working with statements like these tells us that " α if β " means " $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$ " and that " α only if β " means " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$." If both of these statements are true, we have " $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$." If both of these statements are true, their conjunction is true.

Definition 2-9. " α if and only if β " means " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ and $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$," that is, " $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$."

Consider the following two statements. "Two lines are parallel if they do not intersect." "Two lines do not intersect if they are parallel." According to Definition 2-9 we may write the conjunction of these two statements as "Two lines are parallel if and only if they do not intersect."

Exercise Group 2-14

In each exercise below there are two statements. Formulate a single statement, using "if and only if," that has the same meaning as the conjunction of these statements.

- If the weather is bad we will stay home. If we stay home the weather is bad.
- If you are a sophomore then you will get a ticket. If you get a ticket then you are a sophomore.
- If the weather is bad we will stay home. If the weather is not bad we will not stay home.
- Everyone who receives more than 50% on this test will pass the course. All others will fail.
- Your dog will obey you if you treat him well. If you do not treat him well he will not obey you.
- I will marry you if you buy me a mink coat. If you don't buy me a mink coat I won't marry you.
- If food is sweet then it has honey in it. Food with honey in it is sweet.

2-9 THEOREMS AND PROOFS

In Section 2-3 we said logic is a study of the rules for making correct statements. The Greek philosopher Aristotle was the first great student of logic. His work was not improved upon until modern times. In fact, all the logical concepts we have studied in this chapter belong to what we call *Aristotelian logic*, which is over 2000 years old and is just as useful today as it ever was. The logical principles of this chapter are all that you will need for many years. If you have found these ideas interesting, you may wish to take courses in logic later on in college. Whether or not you continue your study of logic, the work of this chapter should help you become careful in both speech and writing. In particular,

during the work in geometry this year, do not tolerate false statements. Remember that if one false statement is accepted as true then strange things can be proved. Let us strive then to express ourselves precisely.

Most of our geometrical work will consist of *proving theorems*. Theorems are statements. To *prove a theorem* is to show that it follows logically from our assumptions. To do so we employ our principles of logic. For example, *if* we know that the statement $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is true *and if* we know that α is true, *then* we can infer that β is true. In symbols,

$$\alpha \text{ and } (\alpha \rightarrow \beta) \rightarrow \beta.$$

Another technique of proof is the following: *If* we know that $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is true *and if* we know that β is false, *then* we can infer that α is false. Symbolically,

$$\text{not } \beta \text{ and } (\alpha \rightarrow \beta) \rightarrow \text{not } \alpha.$$

You need only look at the truth table for $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ to realize that the two rules above are correct.

α	β	$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$
T	T	T
T	F	F
F	T	T
F	F	T

Problem. Explain how this truth table justifies the two methods of proof described above.

Let us illustrate how these proof techniques may be employed (although you have already reasoned in this way in many exercises in this chapter).

Example 1. The notice said, "If it rains on commencement day then the graduation ceremony will be held in the gymnasium." ($\alpha \rightarrow \beta$.) Today is commencement day and it is raining. (α is true.) Therefore, since both of the statements α and $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ are true, we know that β is true. That is, the graduation ceremony will be held in the gymnasium.

Example 2. Jim says that -3 is a root of the equation $x^2 - x - 6 = 0$. If -3 is a root of the equation $x^2 - x - 6 = 0$, then $(-3)^2 - (-3) - 6 = 0$. ($\alpha \rightarrow \beta$.) But, $(-3)^2 - (-3) - 6 = 6$. (β is false.) Now, since $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ is true and β is false, I know that α is false and Jim was wrong. The number -3 is not a root of the equation $x^2 - x - 6 = 0$.

In these examples we would say that we have proved the theorems,

1. The graduation ceremony will be held in the gym.
2. The number -3 is not a root of $x^2 - x - 6 = 0$.

We might have written out our proofs as follows, in a "statement-reason" form.

STATEMENTS	REASONS
1. Rain on commencement day $\rightarrow$ ceremony in gym.	1. Given.
2. It is raining on commencement day.	2. Given.
3. The ceremony will be in the gym.	3. Statements 1 and 2 and laws of logic.

STATEMENTS	REASONS
1. -3 is a root of $x^2 - x - 6 = 0$	1. Definition of root.
$\rightarrow (-3)^2 - (-3) - 6 = 0$.	
2. $(-3)^2 - (-3) - 6 \neq 0$.	2. Arithmetic.
3. -3 is not a root of $x^2 - x - 6 = 0$.	3. Statements 1 and 2 and laws of logic.

Exercise Group 2-15

In each problem below you are given certain statements which we shall call true. Then a theorem is stated. In some cases the theorem may be false; in others there may not be enough information given to decide whether the theorem is true or false. Write out proofs. We refer to our given true statements in each problem as our *hypothesis* (hyp).

1. **Hyp:** Uncle George will take us skating today if Mother says we may go. Mother has said we may go.

Theorem: Uncle George will take us skating today.

2. **Hyp:** If there is no oxygen upon the moon then there can be no animal life there. Tests have shown conclusively that there is no oxygen upon the moon.

Theorem: There is no animal life on the moon.

3. **Hyp:** People with green eyes cannot be trusted. Joan has green eyes.

Theorem: Joan cannot be trusted.

4. **Hyp:** People with blue eyes are honest. Henry is dishonest.

Theorem: Henry does not have blue eyes.

5. **Hyp:** If Joe parts his hair on the left then he does not like spinach. Joe does not like spinach.

Theorem: Joe parts his hair on the left.

6. **Hyp:** Cats with green whiskers have long tails. Cats who do not like milk do not have long tails. Simba is a cat who does not like milk.

Theorem: Simba does not have green whiskers.

7. **Hyp:** A student who attends M.I.T. will spend more than \$1200 during the school year. Kate spent \$980 last year in school.

Theorem: Kate did not attend M.I.T. last year.

8. **Hyp:** $x + y = 20$. $x - y = 4$.

Theorem: $x \neq 11$.

9. *Hyp:* $2x + 3y = 7$, $x + 2y = 3$.
Theorem: $3x - y = 10$.
10. *Hyp:* Joe has 11 marbles: four blue ones and seven yellow ones. Joe gave his sister six marbles. Joe did not give all his blue marbles away.
Theorem: Joe does not have more than four yellow marbles left.
11. *Hyp:* Only those students whose test grades average more than 90% will receive A's for their semester's work in geometry. Jim's test grades have been 89, 84, 92, 85, and 100. Sally's scores are 91, 90, 89, 94, and 87.
Theorem: Sally will receive an A and Jim will not.
12. *Hyp:* The lovely actress Amanda Thistle has promised to marry her honest admirer Silas Moneybags only if he buys her a mink stole, a yacht, and the great Calcutta Emerald. Silas has purchased for his Amanda these items and many others. Amanda always keeps her promises.
Theorem: Amanda will wed Silas.
13. *Hyp:* $x + y = 10$. x and y are positive whole numbers. x is greater than y . $y + 4$ is greater than x .
Theorem: $y = 4$.
14. *Hyp:* The square of a positive number is positive. The square of a negative number is positive. The square of zero is zero. Zero is neither positive nor negative. k is a number. $k^2 = -1$.
Theorem: There are numbers which are not positive or negative or equal to zero.
15. *Hyp:* The product of two positive numbers is positive. The number a is positive. The product of numbers a and b is not positive.
Theorem: The number b is negative.
- *16. *Hyp:* If a is any number, then $1 \cdot a = a$. If a, b, c are any numbers, then $ba + ca = (b + c)a$. $1 + 1 = 2$.
Theorem: For every number a , it is true that $a + a = 2 \cdot a$.
- *17. *Hyp:* $4 + (-4) = 0$. $6 = 2 + 4$. For all numbers a, b, c , it is true that $(a + b) + c = a + (b + c)$. We always have $x + 0 = x$.
Theorem: $6 + (-4) = 2$.
- *18. *Hyp:* If $8 + x = 0$ then $x = -8$. $8 = 3 + 5$. Numbers can be rearranged when we add them. $3 + (-3) = 0$. $5 + (-5) = 0$. $0 + 0 = 0$.
Theorem: $(-3) + (-5) = -8$.
- *19. *Hyp:* If neither of two numbers is equal to zero then their product is not zero. The product of the two numbers a and b is zero. $b \neq 0$.
Theorem: $a = 0$.
- *20. *Hyp:* Dogs with long ears have short tails. Dogs who chase rabbits never get measles. Dogs who do not chase rabbits have long tails. My dog Rover died of the measles.
Theorem: Rover did not have long ears.

REVIEW OF CHAPTER 2

The ideas in this chapter are not to be memorized as you may have memorized the addition and multiplication tables when you studied arithmetic. It is very important that you realize that *all* our complicated mathematical statements may be built up from simple statements using only the connectives "and," "or," "not," and "if . . . then." You should relate the precise meaning of other connectives like "only if" and "if and only if" to these four fundamental terms. *Do not* make any effort to memorize the meanings of these latter terms. You should remember the meaning of conjunction, disjunction, negation, implication, and equivalence. You should be able to form the converse or contrapositive of an implication. You should be able to give examples showing that two statements, " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$," and the converse, " $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$," are not necessarily equivalent to each other, that is, that one might be true and the other false. You should see clearly that the implication " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " and its contrapositive, "not $\beta \rightarrow$ not α ," really assert the same thing; hence they are equivalent statements. You should understand and be able to use the important rules of logic employed so often in proofs, namely,

1. α and $(\alpha \rightarrow \beta) \rightarrow \beta$.
2. not β and $(\alpha \rightarrow \beta) \rightarrow$ not α .

You should understand how to set up and use truth tables. For example, to set up a truth table for the statement " α and $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$," we could list the following:

α	β	$\alpha \rightarrow \beta$	α and $(\alpha \rightarrow \beta)$
T	T	T	?
T	F	F	?
F	T	T	?
F	F	T	?

Problem. Fill in the last column in the truth table above and show that when the statement " α and $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " is true, then β is true also. Make a similar truth table to illustrate the second rule of logic listed above. Can you invent a rule of logic like these two and show that it is correct by setting up a truth table?

Review Exercises

- Under what condition is " α and β " a true statement? Give examples.
- Give an example to show why we call " α or β " true when both α and β are true.
- What is the negation of not α ? Give examples.
- Make up a statement of the form " α and β ." State its negation.
- Make up a statement of the form " α or β ." State its negation.
- What is meant by " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ "? Give two statements having this form, one of which is true and the other false.
- Why is the statement " α or not α " true no matter whether α is true or false? Give examples to illustrate this.
- Construct a truth table to show under what condition " $(\alpha$ and $\beta)$ or γ " is a true statement. Invent an example of this type.
- Give an example of an implication " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$ " whose converse is true and one whose converse is false.
- Form the converse of:
 - If a man is from Chicago then he is rich.
 - If she sings in the choir then I will not go to church.
 - If Smith is elected president he will get ulcers.
 - You must be a sophomore if you are taking geometry.
 - Only the brave are free.
- Form the contrapositive of each implication in Exercise 10.
- Write a statement equivalent to:
 - Sweet food always has honey in it.
 - My rheumatism never bothers me in warm weather.
 - In order to be healthy you must drink milk.
 - A grade of 80% on the final examination will be sufficient to pass the course.
 - Sophomores may come to the dance, but no one else will be permitted to do so.
- Write the negation of:
 - Honesty is the best policy.
 - All math teachers are brutes.
 - The potato crop will fail and everyone will starve.
 - Roses are red and violets are blue, sugar is sweet and I love you.
 - Some cats can swim but no chickens can.

There are two statements in each exercise below. Calling the first statement α and the second one β , rewrite them in the symbolic form " α and β ," " α or β ," " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$," " $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$," " $\alpha \rightarrow$ not β ," " $\alpha \leftrightarrow \beta$," etc., as the case may be. For example, the statement, "A man is honest if he has big feet" would be written " $\beta \rightarrow \alpha$," not " $\alpha \rightarrow \beta$."

- Vacation begins May 12 but we are not going any place.
- A man on the faculty must park his car in the main parking lot.

16. You will not receive an A in geometry if you do not work this example correctly.

17. Mother will let me go to the dance if and only if I wash the dishes for a week.

18. Students who laugh at his jokes are the only ones who get good grades.

19. It is necessary that we have rain this week if the melon crop is to be good.

20. You will write a term paper or you will fail.

21. This is the last exercise and I am glad that it is.

ALGEBRA REVIEW

In the exercises below we indicate some of the ways that logical reasoning is used in algebra. First we shall list some statements that we agree to call *true* in algebra. Then we shall set up algebraic problems which provide opportunities to use these true statements and reason logically to correct conclusions. In what follows, all letters refer to integers, that is, whole numbers in the set $(\dots, -3, -2, -1, 0, 1, 2, \dots)$. Let us agree that the following statements are true:

- For all integers a, b, c it is true that if $a + b = a + c$, then $b = c$.
- For all integers a, b, c it is true that if $ab = ac$ and $a \neq 0$, then $b = c$.

Let us prove the theorem: If $x = 5$ then $3x + 4 = 19$.

Proof. If $x = 5$ then $3x + 4 = 3 \cdot 5 + 4 = 15 + 4 = 19$.

Let us prove the converse of the above theorem, namely: If $3x + 4 = 19$ then $x = 5$.

Proof. $3x + 4 = 19 \rightarrow 3x + 4 = 15 + 4$. Now, by statement (1) above we know that $3x + 4 = 15 + 4 \rightarrow 3x = 15$ and that $3x = 15 \rightarrow 3x = 3 \cdot 5$. Using statement (2) above, we have $3x = 3 \cdot 5 \rightarrow x = 5$. We could present this proof briefly in the form:

$$3x + 4 = 19 \rightarrow 3x + 4 = 3 \cdot 5 + 4 \rightarrow 3x = 3 \cdot 5 \rightarrow x = 5.$$

Exercises

- Prove that if $x = 7$ then $4x + 5 = 33$.
- Prove the converse of the statement in Exercise 1.
- Prove that if $7x + 9 = 65$ then $x = 8$, and conversely.
- Prove that $5x + (-3) = 27$ only if $x = 6$.

5. Prove that $x = 11$ is a necessary condition for $5x + 4 = 59$.

6. Prove that if $x = 11$, $5x + 4 = 59$.

7. Prove that $2x + 7 = 19$ if and only if $4x - 3 = 21$.

8. Prove that there is no number x such that $3x + 5 = 11$ and $4x - 1 = 3$.

9. What can you infer if it is known that $a \neq 0$ and $a(3b + 8) = a$?

10. What can you prove if it is known that $r(7b + 5) = r$?

11. It is given that $(3a + 12)(2b + 8) = 0$ and $b \neq 4$. What can be proved?

*12. It is known that $(2a + 3)(b + 3) = 2a + 2$. Prove that if $a = 1$ then $b = 3$. Prove that if $a \neq 1$ then $b \neq 3$. What are the values of a and b if $a \neq 1$? (Remember that a and b are whole numbers.)